

Permanency Planning & Reunification

Learner guide | SWP-003 | School of Child & Family Welfare

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Permanency Planning & Reunification. By the end of the course, you should be able to develop timely, child-centred permanency plans and assess reunification readiness.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Develop timely, child-centred permanency plans and assess reunification readiness.
- Apply the key ideas from Permanency principles.
- Apply the key ideas from Reunification practice.
- Apply the key ideas from Alternative permanency.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Permanency principles	stability, attachment, timelines, child participation, and concurrent planning	10 to 15 minutes
2. Reunification practice	readiness indicators, parent support, supervised contact, risk reassessment, and transition planning	10 to 15 minutes
3. Alternative permanency	guardianship, adoption, long-term care, cultural continuity, and case review	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Permanency principles

This module focuses on stability, attachment, timelines, child participation, and concurrent planning. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Stability
- Attachment
- Timelines
- Child participation
- Concurrent planning

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of permanency principles in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of stability, attachment, timelines, child participation, and concurrent planning. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through permanency principles safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Reunification practice

This module focuses on readiness indicators, parent support, supervised contact, risk reassessment, and transition planning. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Readiness indicators
- Parent support
- Supervised contact
- Risk reassessment
- Transition planning

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of reunification practice in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of readiness indicators, parent support, supervised contact, risk reassessment, and transition planning. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through reunification practice safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Alternative permanency

This module focuses on guardianship, adoption, long-term care, cultural continuity, and case review. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Guardianship
- Adoption
- Long-term care
- Cultural continuity
- Case review

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of alternative permanency in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of guardianship, adoption, long-term care, cultural continuity, and case review. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through alternative permanency safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: child-centred decision making.
- Review the distinction between: concurrent planning.
- Review the distinction between: readiness evidence.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.